

DC₂₀

CLASS REFERENCE



BARD

DC₂₀ Beta 0.10.5 - standalone reference



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SOURCE & USE

This standalone reference compiles the official Bard class pages from DC20 Beta 0.10.5 and adds a compact Level 1 quick-reference page. Rules text on the class pages is reproduced directly from the user-provided rulebook; the quick reference is a concise restatement for play at the table.

Created for personal table use.

BARD

Bards utilize artistic expression through various forms to connect with the emotions and heart of magic. This includes a wide range of mediums such as musical instruments, singing, dancing, drawing, painting, sculpting, poetry, storytelling, inspirational speech, and more. They are great at bringing the best out in those around them through both helping and performing, showcasing high proficiency across multiple disciplines. Bards are remarkably flexible and adaptable spellcasters, capable of tapping into a wide array of magical abilities with the appropriate artistic expression.

Source of Power: Bards derive their power from harnessing their emotions and force of will, as well as those of others around them. The feeling you get when listening to a stirring song, hearing masterfully read poetry, or witnessing a captivating performance that gives you chills, elevates your heart rate, and provokes you to dance, that passion is what fuels their potential. A Bard's emotion, determination, and willpower flows through their unique artistic expression, touching the hearts and minds of those around them and bringing their magic to life.

Bard Flavor: Bards compile a repertoire of artistic expressions that they manifest as Spells. Musician Bards utilize specific songs or instruments to cast Spells, while dancer Bards perform particular dance moves that represent different Spells. Storyteller Bards initiate combat by narrating tales of wonder and adventure, seamlessly weaving Spells into key points of the story. Painter Bards fluidly and freely paint images, each triggering a specific Spell.

BARD CLASS TABLE

CHAR LEVEL	HEALTH POINTS	ATTRIBUTE POINTS	SKILL POINTS	TRADE POINTS	MANA POINTS	SPELLS KNOWN	FEATURES
1	+7				+6	+4	Class Features
2	+1						Class Feature, Talent, Path Progression
3	+1	+1	+1	+1	+3	+1	Subclass Feature
4	+1						Talent, 2 Ancestry Points, Path Progression
5	+1	+1	+2	+1	+3	+1	Class Feature
6	+1		+1				Talent, Path Progression
7	+1				+3	+1	Subclass Expert Feature
8	+1	+1	+1	+1			Talent, 2 Ancestry Points, Path Progression
9	+1				+3	+1	Class Capstone Feature
10	+1	+1	+2	+1	+3	+1	Subclass Capstone Feature

STARTING EQUIPMENT

Arsenal: Choose 3 of any of the following items: Spell Focus, Weapon, or Light Shield.

Armor: 1 set of Light Armor.

Trade Tools: Choose 1 of any of the following items: Calligrapher's Supplies, Disguise Kit, Gaming Kit, Musical Instrument, or Sculptor's Tools.

Adventuring Pack: Choose 1 of the following packs: (Adventuring Packs Coming Soon).

BARD SPELLCASTING PATH

Combat Training: Spell Focuses, Light Armor, Light Shields

Spell List: When you learn a new Spell, you can choose any Spell from the Enchantment Spell School or with the following Spell Tags: Embolden, Enfeeble, Healing, Illusion, or Sound.

Spells Known: The number of Spells you know increases as shown in the Spells Known column of the Bard Class Table.

Mana Points: Your maximum number of Mana Points increases as shown in the Mana Points column of the Bard Class Table.

BARD CLASS

FEATURES

LEVEL 1 CLASS FEATURES

FONT OF INSPIRATION

You are an ever present source of aid for your allies. You gain the following benefits:

- **Ranged Help Attack:** The range of your Help Action when aiding an Attack increases to 10 Spaces.
- **Help Reaction:** When a creature you can see makes a Check, you can take the Help Action as a Reaction to aid them with their Check, provided you're within range to do so.

DC Tip: Helping with a Skill or Trade Check doesn't have a default range limitation. The GM determines the range of the type of help required.

REMARKABLE REPERTOIRE

You've picked up a few tricks along your travels, granting you the following benefits:

Jack of All Trades: You gain 2 Skill Points.

Magical Secrets: You learn any 2 Spells of your choice from any Spell List.

Magical Expression: You learn to express your art in a unique manner, granting you the ability to alter how you cast Spells. Choose the manner of your expression: Visual or Auditory.

- **Visual:** Through acrobatics, dancing, juggling, painting, drawing, or miming, you can ignore the Verbal Components of a Spell you cast, but you must provide a Somatic Component instead.
- **Auditory:** Through singing, playing music, poetry, comedy, or storytelling, you can ignore the Somatic Components of a Spell you cast, but you must provide a Verbal Component instead.

CROWD PLEASER (FLAVOR FEATURE)

When you spend at least 5 minutes performing an Artistry Trade for one or more people who are actively watching or listening to your performance, you can make an Artistry Trade Check Contested by the targets' Charisma Save.

Success: You gain ADV on Charisma Checks against the target for 1 hour or until you become hostile. Creatures have ADV on the Save if they're considered hostile toward you.

DC Tip: If the performance is in front of a lot of people, the GM might decide to roll for ALL "commoners" in one single Save. For example, a group of commoners' Charisma Save would probably only be a +1 or so. If there were also important NPCs within the crowd, then they could roll for those individually.

LEVEL 2 CLASS FEATURES

BARDIC PERFORMANCE

You can spend 1 AP and 1 MP to start a performance that grants you a 10 Space Aura for 1 minute. Choose 1 of the performances below. While creatures of your choice are within your Aura (and can see or hear you) they benefit from your performance. A creature can only benefit from one instance of each performance at a time.

- **Battle Ballad:** The chosen creatures gain a d4 bonus to the first Attack Check they make on each of their turns.
- **Fast Tempo:** The chosen creatures gain +1 Speed.
- **Inspiring:** The chosen creatures gain 1 Temp HP at the start of each of their turns.
- **Emotional:** Choose 1 of the following Conditions: **Charmed**, **Frightened**, **Intimidated**, or **Taunted**. The chosen creatures have Resistance against the chosen Condition. If a target is effected by the chosen Condition at the start of its turn, it can immediately attempt to end the Condition on itself by Repeating its Save.

Changing Performances: Once on each of your turns, you can spend 1 AP to change your performance to a different one.

Ending Early: The performance ends early if you become **Incapacitated**, you die, or choose to end it for free.

TALENT

You gain 1 Talent of your choice. If the Talent has any prerequisites, you must meet those prerequisites to choose that Talent.

PATH PROGRESSION

You gain the benefits of the Martial Path or Spellcaster Path.

LEVEL 3 CLASS FEATURES

SUBCLASS

Choose one of the following options to become your Subclass and gain its Level 3 Features:

- **Eloquence**
- **Jester**
- **Paragon**

LEVEL 4 CLASS FEATURES

TALENT

You gain 1 Talent of your choice. If the Talent has any prerequisites, you must meet those prerequisites to choose that Talent.

PATH PROGRESSION

You gain the benefits of the Martial Path or Spellcaster Path.

ANCESTRY POINTS

You gain 2 Ancestry Points.

LEVEL 5 EXPERT FEATURE

EXPERT BARD

You gain the following benefits for your Bard Class Features.

FONT OF INSPIRATION

Your Help Die now starts at a d10.

REMARKABLE REPERTOIRE

You gain 2 Skill Points and learn any 2 Spells of your choice from any Spell List.

BARDIC PERFORMANCE

Changing Performances: You can change your performance at the start of each of your turns for free.

When you start your Bardic Performance you can spend an additional 2 MP to improve the performances in the following ways:

- *Battle Ballad:* The size of the die increases to a d8.
- *Fast Tempo:* The Speed increases by 2.
- *Inspiring:* The Temp HP increases by 1.
- *Emotional:* The chosen creatures have Resistance against all of the listed Conditions.

LEVEL 6 CLASS FEATURES

TALENT

You gain 1 Talent of your choice. If the Talent has any prerequisites, you must meet those prerequisites to choose that Talent.

PATH PROGRESSION

You gain the benefits of the Martial Path or Spellcaster Path.

SUBCLASSES

ELOQUENCE

BEGUILING PRESENCE

You gain the following benefits:

- **Enthrall:** You learn the *Charm* Spell, and it doesn't end as a result of the target taking damage. If you already know it, you instead learn another spell with the Charmed Tag.
- **Misleading Muse:** When a creature within your **Bardic Performance** targets only you with an Attack, you can spend 1 AP as a Reaction to make a Spell Check against the target's Attack Check. **Success:** The creature becomes **Charmed** by you until the end of your next turn. It must target a different creature of its choice (other than itself) within range, or the Attack fails.
- **Mind Games:** When the **Charmed** Condition ends on a creature **Charmed** by you, you can choose to immediately deal 1 Psychic damage to them.

ELOQUENT ORATOR (FLAVOR FEATURE)

Your speech is magically enchanted. Creatures can always understand the words you speak, provided they speak at least 1 Language.

JESTER

ANTAGONIZING ACT

You gain the following benefits:

Heckle: Once per Round when a creature of your choice within your **Bardic Performance** fails a Save, they're **Taunted** by you on the next Attack they make before the end of their next turn.

Distraction: When a hostile creature within 10 Spaces of you makes an Attack, you can spend 1 AP as a Reaction to roll a Help Die and subtract the result from the target's Check.

Pratfall: When you fail a Save imposed by a hostile creature, you can grant a creature within your **Bardic Performance** ADV on a Check of their choice before the end of their next turn.

COMEDIAN (FLAVOR FEATURE)

You have ADV on Checks to make other creatures laugh.

BARD - LEVEL 1 QUICK REFERENCE

BASE HP

7 + **Might** + **Ancestry**

MANA

6 **MP**

SPELLS

4 **Known**

AP

4

CM / MSL

1 / 1 **MP**

SPELLCASTING

- Spell List: learn Spells from the Enchantment School, or Spells with the Embolden, Enfeeble, Healing, Illusion, or Sound Tags.
- Combat Training: Spell Focuses, Light Armor, Light Shields.
- Mana Spend Limit at Level 1 is 1 MP per MP Effect. AP costs are separate.

STARTING EQUIPMENT

- Arsenal: choose 3 - Spell Focus, Weapon, or Light Shield.
- Armor: 1 set of Light Armor.
- Choose 1 Trade Tool from Calligrapher's Supplies, Disguise Kit, Gaming Kit, Musical Instrument, or Sculptor's Tools.

FONT OF INSPIRATION

- Ranged Help Attack: the range of your Help Action when aiding an Attack increases to 10 Spaces.
- Help Reaction: when a creature you can see makes a Check, you can take the Help Action as a Reaction, provided you are within range.

REMARKABLE REPERTOIRE

- Jack of All Trades: gain 2 Skill Points.
- Magical Secrets: learn any 2 Spells of your choice from any Spell List.

MAGICAL EXPRESSION

- Visual: ignore Verbal Components, but provide a Somatic Component instead.
- Auditory: ignore Somatic Components, but provide a Verbal Component instead.

HELP NOTES

- Helping with a Skill or Trade Check has no default range limitation; the GM determines the range required by the type of help.
- Ranged Help Attack extends the Help Action to 10 Spaces when aiding an Attack.

CROWD PLEASER

After performing an Artistry Trade for at least 5 minutes, make an Artistry Trade Check contested by the audience Charisma Save. On success, gain ADV on Charisma Checks against that target for 1 hour or until you become hostile.